Check the meaning before the number

When income differs, preserve source, basis, period and coverage first. Then ask whether the amounts should match and what needs further review.

THE SOURCE LABELS

Keep three sources separate

Label self-reported income, document values and provider output separately.

Preserve the originals; one unexplained amount makes differences harder to review.

Ask: gross or net?

Plaid Bank Income describes net-income information; Payroll Income includes gross-income information.

Check the product and field before treating them as equivalent.

A difference can start with definitions

Illustrative: $5,000 reported gross monthly pay versus $4,100 in net deposits.

They don't measure the same thing; the $900 difference alone doesn't establish dishonesty.

Check the payment frequency

Weekly, every two weeks and twice monthly differ.

Confirm frequency before annualizing regular pay; an unlabeled payment doesn't establish a monthly total.

AN ILLUSTRATIVE CALCULATION

Frequency changes the monthly equivalent

Illustrative gross pay: $2,400/period.

Twice monthly: $2,400 × 24 ÷ 12 = $4,800/month.

Every two weeks: $2,400 × 26 ÷ 12 = $5,200/month.

Annualized, not monthly cash receipts.

THE COVERAGE LIMITS

Check what the source covers

One connected account can omit income deposited elsewhere.

Record covered accounts, periods and unresolved gaps; incomplete coverage isn't the household's total income.

THE TIME PERIOD

Check timing and unusual periods

Paystubs and bank history can cover different dates.

Separate bonuses, partial periods and pay changes; one unusual payment doesn't establish recurring income.

Write the explanation, not an accusation

Record differing definitions, missing evidence and who reviews it.

Document requests need approved communication; an unresolved mismatch doesn't authorize an automatic outcome.

Keep the demonstration boundary visible

Synthetic paystubs and Plaid Sandbox demonstrate evidence handling, not verified consumer income.

Production provider selection still requires permission, eligibility and policy review.

A REUSABLE NOTE

Use this reconciliation note

Source.

Gross/net basis.

Pay frequency.

Covered dates.

Coverage limits.

Conversion method.

Unresolved difference.

Reviewer and next step.

Attach original values so others can check the explanation.